



PARISH NEWSLETTER

T: 028 7126 2360 E: threepatrons@derrydiocese.org W: threepatrons.org

Fr Micheál McGavigan PP – Fr Roni Zacharias CC – Fr Stephen Ward CC

Sunday 27th September 2026 – Twenty Sixth Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A

In this weekend's Gospel, Jesus tells the story of two sons. One initially refuses his father's request but later changes his mind and does what is asked. The other says all the right things but never follows through. The parable reminds us that God is less interested in fine words than in hearts that are willing to change and follow his will. Jesus challenges those who considered themselves righteous by pointing out that the tax collectors and sinners listened to John the Baptist and changed their lives, while others remained closed to God's invitation. The key word in the Gospel is "afterwards". The first son thought better of his decision and acted differently. The message is one of hope. None of us is perfect, and all of us have moments when we resist God's call. Yet God never gives up on us. He is not looking for perfect people, but for open hearts that are willing to begin again and take the next step in faith.

WELCOME TO GOD'S FAMILY

Clara Rose Priestly; Freddie John Stanley Brown;
Lochlan Paul Pyne; Emily Jane McGinley.

REQUIESCANT IN PACE

We offer our sympathies to the family and friends of:
Ronnie Deehan, Elmgrove; Margaret Lyttle, Elmgrove;
Mary Kelly, Fortwilliam Terrace; Maria Conway, Windridge
Drive; Pat Gallagher, Bracken Park.

ANNIVERSARIES

Margaret O'Reilly; June Padmore; Charlie O'Donnell;
Sarah Gray; Kathleen Sharkey; Willie John Brown;
Raymond O'Reilly; Eileen Doherty; Gerry Nicholl;
Lily Whoriskey; Johnny White; Eamon Logan;
Jordan McConomy; Roy McMonagle

READINGS FOR SUNDAY 4th October

1st: Isaiah 5:1-7.. Psalm: 79:9, 12-16, 19-20, R/ Is 5:7
2nd: Philippians 4:6-9. Gospel: Matthew 21:33-43.

EUCCHARISTIC ADORATION

Adoration is the act of worshipping God present in the Eucharist; therefore, it is important to have a constant presence before the Blessed Sacrament. Adoration takes place in St Joseph's Church on Tuesday after 11am Mass until 7pm and in St Patrick's Church on Wednesdays from 10.30am -4pm in The Emmaus Room. We would encourage people to sign up for a rota so that the Blessed Sacrament is not left alone. There will be a sign up sheet available in St Joseph's Church Porch or you can contact the Parish Office. We encourage everyone take part.

THREE PATRONS MONTHLY CASH PRIZE DRAW

November: 5 x £100; 1 x £500; Top Prize £1,000. December: 5 x £100; 1 x £500; JUMBO PRIZE £2,000. Tickets cost £20. Monthly promoter prize of £50 for each winning ticket. Tickets are available from Church sacristies and Parish Offices. Card payments available at the Pennyburn Parish Office. Draws take place Friday, 20th November & Friday 18th December.

LECTIO DIVINA ON SUNDAY'S GOSPEL

Take some time to pray, reflect and share as we explore the Gospel for the coming Sunday. Monday after the 10am Mass in the Emmaus Room, Pennyburn.

CHILDREN'S LITURGY

Every Sunday in our three Churches: 9.45am Mass in St Patrick's Church, Pennyburn; 10.30am Mass in St Brigid's Church, Carnhill and 11am Mass in St Joseph's Church, Galliagh. All children P1 to P4 are welcome - Come along and join the fun as we sing, pray and grow together in faith!

ST BRIGID'S CHURCH, CARHILL - JUNIOR CHOIR

Sunday 10.30am Mass. We welcome anyone from Primary 4 upwards. Practice takes place on Tuesday's 5pm-5.30pm

OPEN HEART- OPEN TO THE WORD

This 4-week programme is an introduction to the practice of praying Scripture in a reflective way. Led by Thornhill Ministries, who are trained in Ignatius prayer, this series of 1-hour gatherings will gently help participants allow the Word of God to nestle in the quiet corner of the heart. Sundays 3:30-4:30pm Emmaus Room, Pennyburn. 4th: 11th; 18th & 25th October.

LAST WEEK'S OFFERTORY COLLECTION

St Patrick's Church: £1,287 - St Brigid's Church: £1,955 - St Joseph's Church: £1,115
2nd Collection (Maintenance & Pastoral Outreach): £1,111.

Thank you for your continued generosity.

**BANK DETAILS FOR ONLINE DONATIONS: A/C Name: The Parish of the Three Patrons
Sort Code: 95-06-79 A/C No: 60320021**

HOLY FACE OF JESUS

You are invited to the Canal Court Hotel, Newry at 6:45pm, on Tuesday 26th September to discuss the Devotion to the Holy Face of Jesus. Everyone welcome.

ANNUAL SAFEGUARDING MASS

Bishop Ruter invites everyone involved in Safeguarding to the Annual Safeguarding Mass on Friday 2 October at 7.30pm in St Eugene's Cathedral. Mass will be offered for peace, reconciliation and healing for all who have suffered the pain of abuse and in thanksgiving for the Parish Safeguarding Representatives in the parishes across the diocese, and diocesan staff and volunteers who continue to work and support ongoing safeguarding practices across our diocese. Everyone is welcome to attend this Mass.

OUR LADY, UNTIER OF KNOTS NOVENA

Will begin after the 7.30pm Mass on Thursday, 1st October in Saint Eugene's Cathedral. It will continue for the following eight Thursdays, concluding on 26th November. Do you have "knots" in your life? Knots of discord in your family, unresolved pain in relationships, or a lack of peace and joy in your home? Sometimes life can feel like one overwhelming knot, especially when we face health challenges or burdens beyond our control. This Novena reminds us that sin never entangled Our Lady, and that Christ gave us His Mother as Our Lady, Untier of Knots. Through this devotion, we entrust our personal "knots" to her loving care—learning to let go and allowing her to gently untie what binds us. All are welcome to join in prayer and reflection during this special time of grace.

AFTERNOON TEA & DANCING IN ST COLUMB'S HALL

Wednesday 30th September from 2pm-4pm. Adm £2.50, pay at the door. In aid of St Vincent de Paul. All welcome.

THE CARE FOR CREATION GROUP

Recognises the importance of the family pet, or pets, within many homes. Accordingly, there will be a Blessing of Family Pets Service in the grounds of St. Brigid's Church, Carnhill, on Saturday 3rd October at 3.15pm. All are invited. Last year, we were delighted to see, and hear, so many pets. We are hoping to welcome an even greater variety of animals this time. Please note that this is an outdoor event.

FIND THE ABLE BEYOND THE LABEL

Free Information Evening for parents and carers of children and young people with learning challenges, with Neurodevelopmental Practitioner Anne-Marie O'Kane, at Culmore Community Hub on Wednesday 30 September, 7:30pm- 8:30pm. Tea and coffee.

EUCCHARISTIC ADORATION

Derry Diocese is renewing and developing its Diocesan Adoration Lay Committee to increase the practice of Eucharistic Adoration in parishes throughout the diocese. You are welcome to attend an Information Meeting on Wed 30th Sept, 8pm in The Drummond Hotel, Ballykelly. BT49 9HP. Registration and light refreshments from 7.30pm. See poster in the church for details.

SAFEGUARDING

If you have any concerns about the Safeguarding of Children or vulnerable adults within the Church, please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596500793 or at dlp@derrydiocese.org

PRIVACY NOTICE

The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations, and a privacy notice is available on the Parish website or by contacting the Parish Office. Livestream and recordings of Mass and services in our Churches are available online. Please note that the front rows of seats are visible online

PARISH GROUPS & MEETINGS

Monday	After 10am Mass	Lectio Divina	Emmaus Room, Pennyburn
	After 11am Mass	Holy Souls Prayer Group	Our Lady's Chapel, Galliagh
	1pm – 2.30pm	Legion of Mary	Meeting Room, St Joseph's Church, Galliagh
	7pm – 8.30pm	Carnhill Folk Group	St Brigid's Church, Carnhill
	7pm - 9pm	Woman's Craft Group	Kildare Room, Carnhill
Tuesday	After 11am Mass	Devotion to the Holy Face	Our Lady's Chapel, Galliagh
	11.30am - 2.30pm	St. Pio's Café	St Pio Centre, Galliagh
	12pm – 1pm	Reflection on Sunday Scriptures	St Pio Centre, Galliagh
	5.00pm – 5.30pm	St Brigid's Junior Choir	St Brigid's Church, Carnhill
	7.30pm - 9.30pm	Living Disciples Prayer Group	St Pio Centre, Galliagh
Thursday	11.30am - 2.30pm	St. Pio's Café	St. Pio Centre, Galliagh
	4.45pm – 5.30pm	St Brigid's Youth Choir	St Brigid's Church, Carnhill
	6pm – 7pm	Divine Will Prayer Group	Kildare Room, Carnhill
	7pm – 8pm	Holy Hour for the Unborn	Our Lady's Chapel
	7.30pm - 8.30pm	Youth Prayer Group	St. Pio Centre, Galliagh
	8.15pm – 10pm	Be Still – Men's Prayer Group	Our Lady's Chapel
Friday	11.30am-12.30pm	Divine Mercy Prayer Group	Our Lady's Chapel, Galliagh
Saturday	12noon – 1pm	The God Club	Kildare Room, Carnhill

PARISH SCHEDULE

ST PATRICK'S CHURCH, PENNYBURN

Sunday Mass:	Vigil 6.15pm; 9.45am
Weekday Mass:	Monday to Friday: 10am; Wednesday: 7pm
Confessions:	Wednesday: 6.15pm – 6.45pm; Saturday: 5.15pm – 6pm
Eucharistic Adoration:	Wednesday: 10.30am – 4pm in the Emmaus Room
Baptisms:	Saturday: 4.30pm; Sunday: 1.30pm

ST BRIGID'S CHURCH, CARNHILL

Sunday Mass:	Vigil 5pm; 10.30am & 12.30pm
Weekday Mass:	Monday to Friday: 9.30am; Thursday: 7pm; Saturday: 11am
Confessions:	Thursday: 6.15pm – 6.45pm; Saturday after 11.00am Mass and 4pm - 4.45pm
Eucharistic Adoration:	Daily: 8.00am – 8.00pm in St Carlo Acutis Chapel
Baptisms:	Saturday: 3.30pm

ST JOSEPH'S CHURCH, GALLIAGH

Sunday Mass:	11.00am; 12.30pm (<i>An tAifreann Naofa</i>); 6.30pm
Weekday Mass:	Monday to Friday: 11am; Tuesday: 7pm
Confessions:	Tuesday: 6.15pm – 6.45pm; Sunday: 5.30pm – 6.15pm
Eucharistic Adoration:	Tuesday: 11.30am – 7.00pm in Our Lady's Chapel
Baptisms:	Saturday: 3.30pm